Past simple: irregular verbs

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Recognise irregular verbs (verbos irregulares) in a text
- Learn the 30 most common irregular past forms
- Use irregular verbs in affirmative, negative and question sentences
- Tell a short story in the past

Para pensar

Si «jugué» es *played*, ¿por qué «fui» no es *goed*?

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Rechazar Aceptar

Explicación

What is an irregular verb?

Regular verbs add -ed: play → played. Irregular verbs don't follow this rule. Each one has its own past form: go → **went**, eat → **ate**, see → **saw**, have → **had**.

The good news: like regular verbs, the past form is the **same for all persons**: «I went», «she went», «they went». And irregular verbs are very common, so you hear them all the time in songs, films and stories. **En castellano:** nosotros también tenemos irregulares: «ir» → «fui», no «í». En inglés es igual: hay que memorizarlos.



The top ten

Start with the ten most useful irregular verbs. You will use them every day: **go → went** (ir), **have → had** (tener), **get → got** (conseguir, llegar), **make → made** (hacer, fabricar), **do → did** (hacer), **see → saw** (ver), **come → came** (venir), **eat → ate** (comer), **take → took** (coger, llevar), **say → said** (decir).

«I **went** to the park and I **saw** my friends. We **had** a picnic and we **ate** sandwiches. Then Marc **came** with his dog and **said** hello.»

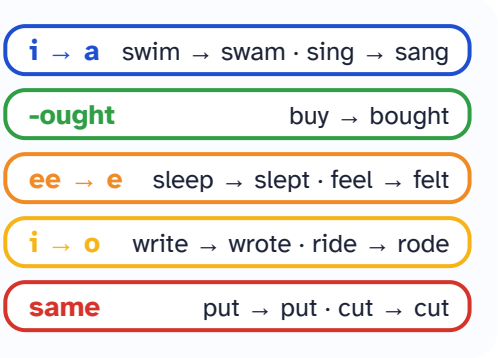
Verb	Past	Verb	Past
go	went	see	saw
have	had	come	came
get	got	eat	ate

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Learn them in families

Many irregular verbs change in a similar way. Learn them in families. **i → a:** swim → swam, sing → sang, drink → drank, begin → began, ring → rang. **-ought / -aught:** buy → bought, bring → brought, think → thought, catch → caught, teach → taught.

ee → e / ea → e: sleep → slept, feel → felt, meet → met, keep → kept. **o-e:** write → wrote, ride → rode, drive → drove. **Same form:** put → put, cut → cut, hit → hit, let → let. **Consejo:** agrupados se recuerdan mucho mejor que en una lista por orden alfabético.



More useful verbs

Here are more irregular verbs for your stories: **run → ran**, **sit → sat**, **stand → stood**, **fall → fell**, **find → found**, **lose → lost**, **win → won**, **give → gave**, **tell → told**, **read → read** (it is written the same but sounds «red»), **wear → wore**, **fly → flew**, **know → knew**, **leave → left**, **break → broke**.

«The bird **flew** away.» «Our team **won** the match!» «I **lost** my keys, but my brother **found** them under the sofa.» «Grandpa **told** us a story.»

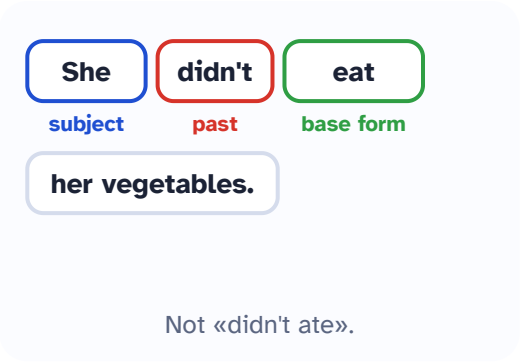


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Negatives: didn't + base form

The negative works exactly like with regular verbs: didn't + the **base form** (the verb as in the dictionary). «I **didn't go** to the party.» «She **didn't eat** her vegetables.» «We **didn't see** the eclipse.»

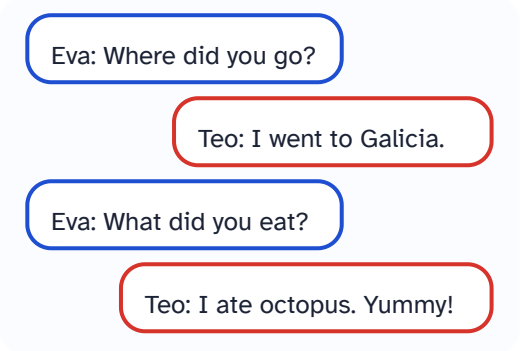
This is a big help: in negatives you **don't need** the irregular form. Not «I didn't went», not «She didn't ate». **En castellano:** piensa que *did* ya «lleva» el pasado; el verbo vuelve a ser el de siempre. Solo tienes que acordarte del irregular en las frases afirmativas.



Questions: Did...? Where did...?

Questions also use did + subject + **base form**: «**Did** you **see** the fireworks?» «Yes, I **did**.» «**Did** he **take** the bus?» «No, he **didn't**. He walked.»

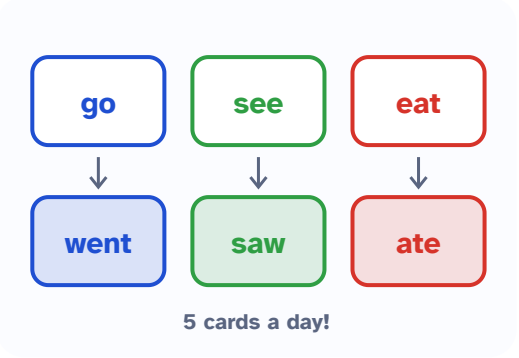
With question words: «**Where did** you **go** on holiday?» «**What did** you **eat**?» «**Who did** you **meet**?» «**What time did** the train **leave**?» The answer uses the irregular past: «I **went** to Galicia.» «I **ate** octopus.» «I **met** my cousins.»



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1. Flashcards: write the verb on one side and the past on the other. Practise five every day. **2. Rhythm:** say them with a beat, clapping: «go – went, see – saw, eat – ate!». **3. Memory game:** place the cards face down and find the pairs.

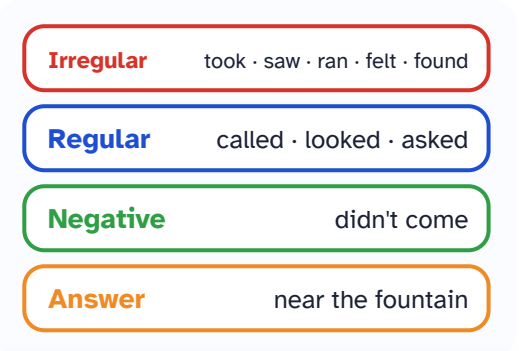
4. Your own sentences: use each new verb in a true sentence about you: «Last summer I **swam** in the sea.» **5. Read stories:** stories in the past are full of irregular verbs. **Consejo:** no intentes aprender cien de golpe. Con los treinta de este tema ya puedes contar casi cualquier cosa.



Reading: the lost dog

Read this story: «Last Sunday, Max **woke** up early and **took** his dog Coco to the park. Coco **saw** a squirrel and **ran** after it. Max **called** her, but she **didn't come** back. Max **felt** very worried. He **looked** everywhere and **asked** people. An old lady **said**: "I **saw** a small dog near the fountain." Max **went** there and he **found** Coco. She **was** wet and happy! They **had** an ice cream and **came** home.»

Underline the irregular verbs in red and the regular ones in blue. What did Coco see? Where did Max find her?



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Play a chain story in groups of four. The first person says a sentence with an irregular verb: «Yesterday a dragon **came** to our school.» The next person continues: «It **ate** all the sandwiches.» «Then it **flew** to the gym.» «Finally it **fell** asleep in the library!»

Write your story and draw it in four pictures. Check each verb: is it regular or irregular? Did you use the base form after *didn't*? **Repaso:** afirmativa con la forma irregular; negativa y pregunta con *did* + verbo básico.

1 A dragon came to school.

2 It ate the sandwiches.

3 Then it flew to the gym.

4 Finally, it fell asleep.

Irregular verbs

learn them!

WENT

go → went
eat → ate

in families

SWAM

swim → swam
buy → bought

negative

DIDN'T

didn't go
base form

question

DID...?

Did you see?
Yes, I did.

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Ejercicios

1. **Write the past: go, have, see, make.**

2. **Write the past: sing, drink, think, catch.**

3. **Complete: «Yesterday I ___ (eat) paella.»**

4. **Complete: «My aunt ___ (give) me a book.»**

5. **Make it negative: «We took a taxi.»**

6. **Make a question: «She wrote a poem.»**

7. **Ask with what: «He bought a skateboard.»**

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9. **Which family? «keep → kept»**

10. **Write four sentences about your best day with irregular verbs.**

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Practica

1. **The past of «go» is...**
   - **A)** goed
   - **B)** gone
   - **C)** went
2. **The past of «eat» is...**
   - **A)** ate
   - **B)** eated
   - **C)** eat
3. **The past of «buy» is...**
   - **A)** buyed
   - **B)** bought
   - **C)** brought
4. **The past of «swim» is...**
   - **A)** swimmed
   - **B)** swam
   - **C)** swum
5. **«I didn't ___ the film.»**
   - **A)** saw
   - **B)** seen
   - **C)** see
6. **«Did you ___ a good time?»**
   - **A)** have
   - **B)** had
   - **C)** has
7. **The past of «put» is...**
   - **A)** putted
   - **B)** pat
   - **C)** put

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B) went

C) did go

9. **The past of «sleep» is...**

A) slept

B) sleeped

C) slep

10. **Which verb is irregular?**

A) write

B) walk

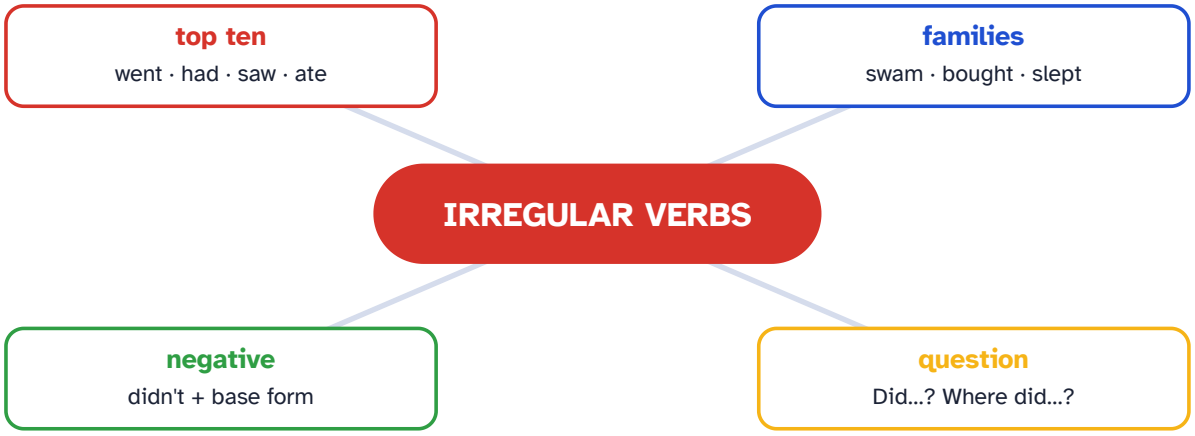
C) play

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué diferencia hay entre un verbo regular y uno irregular; Cuáles son los diez irregulares más usados y su pasado; Por qué en negativas y preguntas no se usa la forma irregular; Qué trucos ayudan a memorizarlos.

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Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

go → went

ir → fui.

have → had

tener → tuve.

see → saw

ver → vi.

eat → ate

comer → comí.

buy → bought

comprar (familia -ought).

swim → swam

nadar (familia i → a).

put → put

Igual en presente y pasado.

didn't + base form

I didn't go (no «didn't went»).

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Soluciones

1. **C)** Irregular.
2. **A)** Irregular.
3. **B)** Familia -ought.
4. **B)** i → a.
5. **C)** Tras didn't, forma básica.
6. **A)** Tras did, forma básica.
7. **C)** Igual que el presente.
8. **B)** Respuesta en afirmativa: went.
9. **A)** ee → e.
10. **A)** write → wrote.

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Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. went, had, saw, made.
2. sang, drank, thought, caught.
3. ate.
4. gave.
5. We didn't take a taxi.
6. Did she write a poem?
7. What did he buy?
8. I didn't see the match, but my team won.
9. ee → e, como sleep → slept y feel → felt.
10. Model answer: I went to the beach. I swam in the sea. We had lunch in a restaurant. I felt very happy.

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